04-13 第二篇

How Pets Help Children Grow

Many families keep pets such as dogs, cats, or rabbits. But did you know that pets can do more than bring joy—they can also help children develop important skills and qualities? [1] Studies show that children who grow up with pets tend to be more responsible, caring, and confident. From learning to feed and walk a pet to understanding that animals have feelings too, children gain real-life lessons that books and classrooms cannot always provide.

One of the clearest benefits is responsibility. When a child takes care of a pet, they learn that another living thing depends on them. [2] Feeding the pet, cleaning its living area, and making sure it has fresh water become part of the daily routine. Parents often find that children with pets are more willing to help with chores at home. The pet becomes a "first job" that teaches kids to follow through on their promises and think about someone other than themselves.

Pets also support children's emotional growth. Many children feel safer talking to a pet when they are sad, angry, or worried. [3] A dog or cat does not judge or give advice—it simply listens and stays close. For kids who find it hard to express their feelings to adults, a pet can be a gentle friend who is always there. This kind of bond can reduce stress and help children understand and manage their emotions better.

Another area where pets make a difference is social skills. Children with pets often find it easier to make friends. [4] Walking a dog in the park or taking a pet to a vet (兽医) visit can start conversations with other children and adults. Pets give children something to talk about and share, which can help shy kids feel more comfortable in social situations. Over time, these small interactions can build confidence and improve communication skills.

[5] In conclusion, pets offer children more than companionship—they support responsibility, emotional health, and social development. Of course, having a pet is a big commitment and not every family can have one. But for those who do, the benefits for children's growth are clear and lasting.

选项

A. These tasks may seem small, but they teach children about commitment and care. B. In short, pets can play an important role in helping children become better people. C. Pets provide a sense of security and unconditional love that helps children feel valued. D. A pet can act as a bridge, helping children connect with others in natural ways. E. The

reason is simple: pets accept children as they are, without criticism. F. Research suggests that children with pets show higher levels of empathy and self-esteem.

答案键（Answer Key）

[1] F [2] A [3] E [4] D [5] B

深度解析

- **[1] F**：
  - **线索**：开篇总领与研究佐证。空前提出"pets can do more than bring joy—they can also help children develop important skills and qualities"，空后具体列举"children who grow up with pets tend to be more responsible, caring, and confident...gain real-life lessons"。F选项"Research suggests that children with pets show higher levels of empathy and self-esteem"（研究表明，养宠物的儿童表现出更高水平的同理心和自尊）中"Research suggests"呼应"Studies show"的学术语气，"empathy and self-esteem"与空后"responsible, caring, and confident"概念相近，自然承接并支撑主题句，衔接顺畅。
- **[2] A**：
  - **线索**：责任感与日常照护。空前提出"When a child takes care of a pet, they learn that another living thing depends on them"，空后列举"Feeding the pet, cleaning its living area, and making sure it has fresh water become part of the daily routine"。A选项"These tasks may seem small, but they teach children about commitment and care"（这些任务看似很小，但它们教会孩子承诺与关怀）中"These tasks"指代空后"Feeding...cleaning...making sure..."的具体任务，"commitment and care"与空前"another living thing depends on them"及空后"follow through on their promises"呼应，衔接自然。
- **[3] E**：
  - **线索**：宠物对情绪的支持与接纳。空前描述"Many children feel safer talking to a pet when they are sad, angry, or worried"，空后解释"A dog or cat does not judge or give advice—it simply listens and stays close...a gentle friend who is always there"。E选项"The reason is simple: pets accept children as they are, without criticism"（原因很简单：宠物接纳孩子本来的样子，不带批评）中"The reason"承接空前"feel safer talking to a pet"的因果逻辑，"accept...without criticism"与空后"does not judge...simply listens"完美对应，解释为何宠物能提供情绪支持，逻辑紧密。
- **[4] D**：

- **线索**：社交技能与宠物作为媒介。空前指出"Children with pets often find it easier to make friends"，空后举例"Walking a dog in the park or taking a pet to a vet...can start conversations...Pets give children something to talk about and share...help shy kids feel more comfortable"。D选项"A pet can act as a bridge, helping children connect with others in natural ways"（宠物可以充当桥梁，帮助孩子以自然的方式与他人建立联系）中"act as a bridge"与空后"start conversations...something to talk about and share"对应，"connect with others in natural ways"与"make friends...social situations"呼应，衔接顺畅。

- **[5] B**：
  - **线索**：全文收束与升华。空[5]位于结尾段段首，空后总结"pets offer children more than companionship—they support responsibility, emotional health, and social development...the benefits for children's growth are clear and lasting"。B选项"In short, pets can play an important role in helping children become better people"（简言之，宠物能在帮助孩子成为更好的人方面发挥重要作用）用"In short"总结全文，"play an important role"与空后"support...responsibility, emotional health, and social development"呼应，"become better people"与"benefits for children's growth"形成升华，收束得当。

- **干扰项分析**：
  - **C. Pets provide a sense of security and unconditional love that helps children feel valued.**：强调宠物的安全感与无条件的爱，易被误填[1]或[3]。但空[1]需引出"Studies show...responsible, caring, confident"的研究结论，F的"Research suggests...empathy and self-esteem"更符合学术引入；空[3]需解释"为何孩子更愿意向宠物倾诉"，E的"accept...without criticism"与空后"does not judge"直接对应，C的"security and unconditional love"偏重结果而非原因，与空前"feel safer talking"的因果链衔接不及E紧密。属"主题相关但逻辑错位"型干扰。